4. Professional Email Requesting Leave Due to Illness

Aim:

To design and compare three prompting techniques for generating a professional sick-leave email.

Procedure:

1. Identify the purpose of the email.
2. Prepare zero-shot, one-shot, and few-shot prompts.
3. Generate emails using each prompt.
4. Compare tone, grammar, formatting, and completeness.

Prompt:

Zero-shot:

Write a professional email requesting leave due to illness. Include a subject, greeting, reason, leave dates, and polite closing.

One-shot:

Example:
Subject: Request for Personal Leave

Dear Manager,

I request leave on [date] due to a personal commitment. I will complete my pending work after returning.

Thank you for your consideration.

Best regards,
[Your Name]

Now write a similar email requesting sick leave.

Few-shot:

Example 1:
Subject: Leave Request
Dear Manager,
I request leave on [date] for a personal reason. Thank you for your understanding.
Regards, [Name]

Example 2:
Subject: Request for One-Day Leave
Dear Sir/Madam,

I would like to request leave on [date]. I will manage my pending responsibilities.
Yours sincerely, [Name]

Now write a professional sick-leave email. Include the illness, dates, pending work, and polite closing.

Output:

Zero-shot:

Dear Sir/Madam,

I am unwell and unable to attend work. I kindly request sick leave on [date] to rest and recover.

I will complete my pending work after returning.

Thank you for your understanding.

Yours sincerely,
[Your Name]

One-shot:

Dear Manager,

I would like to request sick leave on [date] because I am not feeling well. I will ensure that my pending tasks are completed after I return.

Thank you for your consideration.

Best regards,
[Your Name]

Few-shot:

Dear Manager,

I am writing to request sick leave from [start date] to [end date] because I am unwell and need time to recover.

I will make the necessary arrangements for my pending responsibilities and update you if my leave needs to be extended.

Kindly approve my leave request.

Thank you for your understanding and support.

Best regards,
[Your Name]

Comparison:

Criteria	**Zero-shot**	**One-shot**	**Few-shot**
Tone	Polite	Follows sample tone	Professional
Grammar	Correct	Correct	Correct
Formatting	Basic email	Follows example	Well structured
Completeness	Covers main details	Covers main details	Includes date range and pending work

Result: Few-shot prompting generated a more complete email, while zero-shot and one-shot produced shorter versions suitable for simple leave requests.